



Fieldwork safety

Roughly a thousand students working across Karachi, October to December · rules, grading and the emergency route

The first question after any incident is what your risk assessment said. This page is the answer, and it has to exist before the first team leaves campus, not after.

There is no insurance. Confirmed on 10 September: there is no policy in this context that covers a student hurt on academic fieldwork. Three things stand in its place and none of them exists yet — a named ceiling the university will meet from the student welfare fund, a standing arrangement with a hospital so treatment is never delayed over payment, and the residual risk accepted in the Steering Group minutes in writing. Until those three exist, everyone reading this page is the control.

Who this binds. Every student, every convener, every teacher of record, on every field visit, including a twenty-minute walk to a shop on the same street. There is no category of fieldwork small enough to be outside it. A team that breaks rules 1, 2, 7 or 9 is stopped from further fieldwork that term and completes the study from published sources.

01 The ten rules		NON-NEGOTIABLE
01	Never alone Fieldwork is done in pairs at minimum, and in threes anywhere graded amber. A student who arrives to find their partner has not come does not start; they go home and rebook. This is the rule that prevents most of what the others are written for.	
02	Daylight only All fieldwork finishes by 6:00 pm in November and December — that is roughly an hour before dark. Night observation, where a project genuinely needs it, requires the convener's written approval, a minimum of three students, and a named adult who knows where they are and when they will call.	
03	Check out, check in Before leaving campus the team messages the convener's group: where, who, and expected return. On return, one message: back. A team that has not checked in within ninety minutes of its stated time triggers the escalation on page 3.	
04	Carry the card and the letter University identity card, visible, plus a printed copy of the fieldwork authorisation letter naming the convener and a phone number that a police officer or a building guard can ring and get an answer from.	
05	Do not display what you are carrying Phones out of sight between uses. No laptops, no cameras with visible lenses, no visible cash, no jewellery, no branded headphones. A phone held low is a survey; a phone held up is an incident waiting to happen.	
06	Public and semi-public places only Streets, parks, markets, bus stops, shopfronts and other people's workplaces only where the owner or manager has agreed. No private residence is entered — a household survey is conducted at the door or in a courtyard, never inside.	
07	No premises without written permission Government offices, hospitals, schools, factories, katchi abadis, port and industrial areas, police stations and any facility with a gate are entered only with written permission obtained through the convener, and the letter is carried.	
08	Never confront, never argue, never photograph a face If someone objects to a student's presence — a shopkeeper, a guard, a resident, an officer — the student apologises, stops, and leaves. No filming, no explaining rights. Nothing in the project is worth the argument.	
09	Any student may abort at any time A student who feels unsafe leaves immediately and does not need to justify it afterwards. Nobody's mark is affected by abandoning a field visit. A convener who questions such a decision has broken this rule, not the student.	
10	Report the same day Every incident, near miss, refusal that turned hostile, or approach by anyone in authority is reported to the convener the same day, on the incident form on page 3 — including the ones where nothing actually happened.	



WHERE

Area grading

Every project location is graded before the field plan is signed

02 Three grades

BY LOCATION

GREEN Routine — pairs, no extra step

Greenwich campus and its immediate streets · DHA Phases I–VIII residential lanes · Clifton Blocks 1–9 residential · PECHS Blocks 2 and 6 residential · shopping malls, university campuses, chain outlets and offices during business hours.

What changes. Standard checks: pairs, daylight, check out and in.

AMBER Three students, convener notified in advance

Saddar and Empress Market · Shahrah-e-Faisal and Khayaban roadsides and signals · Peoples Bus and Pink Bus routes and stops · wholesale markets, transport depots and workshops · any location where the team is stationary and visible for more than an hour.

What changes. Three students. Convener told the day before. No stationary observation from a parked car. Where the study requires counting at a signal, stand on the pavement, never in the carriageway, and never at a signal after 5:00 pm.

RED Not without written approval and an escort

Any katchi abadi · industrial estates, the port and its approaches · landfill and waste-picking sites · police stations, prisons and probation offices · hospital wards and clinical areas · any site reached by a road the team has not seen in daylight.

What changes. Convener's written approval, a named institutional host expecting the team, a faculty member or approved alumnus accompanying, and a fixed return time. A team is never sent to a red site to gather data that a Tier 1 desk route could produce.

Grading is by conditions, not by postcode. The same street is green at eleven in the morning and amber at six in the evening; a market is green from the pavement and amber inside. Where a convener and a team disagree, the higher grade applies. Nobody has ever been criticised for over-grading a site.

03 The field plan

FORM F1

One per team, before the first visit. Renewed if the location or the time of day changes.

TEAM ID	PROJECT TITLE	CONVENER
LOCATION(S)	GRADE (G / A / R)	DAYS & HOURS
MEMBERS ATTENDING (MIN. 2, OR 3 IF AMBER)		TEAM PHONE IN THE FIELD
TWO THINGS THAT COULD GO WRONG HERE, AND WHAT THE TEAM WILL DO		
ETHICS TIER REACHED (FROM THE SCREENING SHEET)	CONVENER SIGNATURE	DATE



WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The route

Four situations, one number, and the same rule in all of them: people first, data never

04 Numbers		CALL IN THIS ORDER
WHO	NUMBER	WHEN
Rescue / ambulance	1122	Any injury. Called first, before the university.
Police	15	Crime in progress. Otherwise report with a member of staff present.
Edhi • Chhipa ambulance	115 • 1020	Alternatives where 1122 does not answer.
Greenwich Works duty phone	[to be issued]	Staffed 9 am – 8 pm, seven days, Oct-Dec. The most important line on this page, and it does not exist yet.
University switchboard	021-111-202-303	Office hours, non-urgent.

05 Four situations	WHAT TO DO
A student is hurt, or someone in front of them is Call 1122 first, then the duty number. Do not move an injured person. One student stays, one calls, nobody films. The convener informs the Registrar within the hour and the parent or guardian the same day.	
A team is approached by police, rangers or agency staff Comply, be polite, hand over the identity card and the authorisation letter, and ask the officer to call the duty number. Do not delete anything. Do not argue about rights. The convener attends in person if asked. The Registrar is told the same day whether or not anything came of it.	
Theft, snatching, or an attempt Give up the phone or the bag. Nothing in a student project is worth resisting for. Move to a lit, populated place, call the duty number, and report to the police only with a member of staff present.	
Harassment of a student, by anyone The team leaves the site immediately and does not return. Reported to the convener the same day and to the university's harassment committee within three days, whether or not the student wants further action. The site is closed to all teams until the Registrar reopens it.	
Escalation Convener → Registrar within one hour for anything involving injury, police, or harassment. Registrar → Pro Vice Chancellor the same day. The PVC informs the Vice Chancellor. Nobody in this chain waits for the next morning, and nobody in it speaks to the press.	



BEFORE ANYONE LEAVES CAMPUS

What the university owes the students

Eleven things that must be true by Session 8 · eight of them are not true today

06 Institutional checklist		THE GATE	
WHAT	OWNER	BY	STATUS
What happens if a student is hurt there is no insurance product to fall back on — so three things replace one	Registrar · Finance	30 Sep	none of the three exists
Duty phone issued and rostered one number, 9 am – 8 pm, Oct–Dec	Secretariat	7 Oct	not started
Identity cards verified for every student in the field	Registrar	Session 7	partial
Fieldwork authorisation letter printed, per team, naming the convener and the duty number	Secretariat	Session 7	not started
A named ceiling from the student welfare fund the sum the university will meet, agreed before anyone goes out	Registrar · Finance	30 Sep	not set
A standing arrangement with a nearby hospital so treatment is never delayed over payment	Registrar	7 Oct	not started
Emergency contact on file for every student	Registrar	30 Sep	exists, unverified
Convener briefing on this document one hour, all 23 conveners, before Session 6	Dr Nawaz	Session 5	not scheduled
Signed field plan on file for every team	Conveners	Session 8	form issued today
Incident log opened every report, including the ones that came to nothing	Registrar	7 Oct	not started
Sites closed list live, visible to all 23 conveners	Secretariat	7 Oct	not started

07 The field card	ISSUE AT SESSION 7
Two-up on card, one per student, issued with the identity card at Session 7. The blanks are filled in by the student, in pen, in class.	
Greenwich Works · field card CUT AND CARRY Rescue / ambulance 1122 Police 15 Edhi · Chhipa 115 · 1020 Greenwich Works duty phone _____ My convener _____ My team lead _____ Never alone. Daylight only. Message out, message back. If anyone objects — apologise, stop, leave. If you feel unsafe, go.	Greenwich Works · field card CUT AND CARRY Rescue / ambulance 1122 Police 15 Edhi · Chhipa 115 · 1020 Greenwich Works duty phone _____ My convener _____ My team lead _____ Never alone. Daylight only. Message out, message back. If anyone objects — apologise, stop, leave. If you feel unsafe, go.



RECORDS

The incident form and the weekly check

Form F2 · plus the five things a convener confirms every week of fieldwork

08	The incident form	FORM F2
TEAM ID	DATE & TIME	LOCATION
WHO WAS PRESENT	ANYONE HURT? (Y/N)	POLICE / AUTHORITY INVOLVED?
WHAT HAPPENED, IN THE STUDENTS' OWN WORDS		
ACTION TAKEN · SITE CLOSED? · REPORTED ONWARD TO		
CONVENER SIGNATURE	RECEIVED BY REGISTRAR	DATE

09	The convener's weekly check	WEEKLY
Five questions, asked of every team under the convener, once a week from Session 8 to Session 13. Two minutes each. It is the only mechanism that catches a team drifting before something happens.		
01	Did you go where the plan says? A team working a site that is not on the signed field plan is working without cover. The plan is amended, not ignored.	
02	Did anyone go alone? Asked plainly, and asked of the team, not the lead. The honest answer to this question in week two prevents the incident in week five.	
03	Anything at all happen? Including the nothings — the guard who asked questions, the man who followed for a street, the shop that objected. These go in the log.	
04	Is anyone in the team uncomfortable about this site? A student will rarely volunteer it. Ask, and be willing to regrade the site on the answer.	
05	Consent forms — how many, and where are they? A count, not an assurance. A team that cannot say where its forms are has a data problem and probably a fieldwork problem too.	

One line in the log beats a memory in December. The convener records the date, the five answers as yes or no, and anything reported. Two lines a week per team. That log is the university's evidence that the rules on page one were not decorative.